

Spirit Procession From Father

doc-spirit-procession-from-father

Pneumatology · Person · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

Supported from a narrow set of texts

Subject named directly in Scripture

Holds across manuscript variants

Statement under examination

The Holy Spirit eternally proceeds from the Father (Nicene-Constantinopolitan confession of 381).

In plain language

John 15:26 in Greek says the Spirit of truth, who proceeds from the Father. The verb translated 'proceeds' is *ekporeuetai*, tagged present indicative third singular (an ongoing, simple statement of fact in the third person singular), and across its 34 places in the New Testament it always means 'to go out' or 'go forth' from a source, used of people leaving a town, words coming out of the mouth, and a river flowing from the throne. Here the neuter relative pronoun 'who' (*ho*) ties this verb to the Spirit (*pneuma*), and the only source phrase attached to it is 'from the Father' (*para tou patros*), where Father (*patēr*) stands in the 'from-X' grammatical form (the genitive of source). So the grammar plainly grounds the Spirit going forth in the Father. The same verse uses a different verb for the Son, 'I will send' (*pempsō*), so sending and proceeding are kept apart by word choice. This pattern holds nearby. In John 14:16 the Son asks and the Father gives the Helper (*paraklētos*). In John 14:26 the Father sends the Spirit in the Son's name. In John 16:7 the Son sends the Spirit, again with the sending verb 'send' (*pempō*), not the procession verb 'proceed' (*ekporeuomai*). In John 20:22 the Son breathes (*emphysaō*) on the disciples, a one-time act described by a verb that occurs only once in the whole canon (a *hapax*), which is a temporal giving, not an origin claim. Why does the verdict land as supported but not at the highest confidence? Because the actual procession statement for the Spirit rests on this one clause, so the words are clear but the canon does not repeat the claim, and because the creedal word 'eternally' reaches beyond what a present-tense verb by itself can say. The text affirms that the Spirit proceeds from the Father. Whether the Spirit also proceeds from the Son is a separate question the procession verb 'proceed' (*ekporeuomai*) does not answer, since that verb never takes the Son as its source.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
G0225	ἀλήθεια	alētheia	truth	110
G1325	δίδωμι	didōmi	to give	415
G1607	ἐκπορεύομαι	ekporeuomai	to depart	34
G1720	ἐμφυσάω	emphysaō	to breathe into	1
G3140	μαρτυρέω	martyreō	to testify	80
G3686	ὄνομα	onoma	name	
G3844	παρά	para	from/with/beside	196

G3875	παράκλητος	paraklētos	counsellor	5
G3962	πατήρ	patēr	father	426
G3992	πέμπω	pempō	to send	81

Plain meanings: STEPbible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: False

John 15:26 reads, in Greek, 'the Spirit of truth, who proceeds from the Father' (to pneuma tēs alētheias ho para tou patros ekporeuetai). The neuter relative pronoun 'who' (ho) agrees with 'the Spirit' (to pneuma) and makes the Spirit the subject of the verb 'proceeds' (ekporeuetai, Strong's G1607), which is tagged V-PNI-3S (an ongoing, simple statement of fact in the third person singular, i.e. present indicative third singular), with the prepositional phrase 'from the Father' (para tou patros, where para is G3844 and patros, 'Father', is G3962 in the genitive of source, i.e. a noun in the 'from-X' grammatical form) as its sole source phrase. STEPbible glosses the verb as 'goes forth, proceeds', and its stable canon sense across 34 occurrences is 'to go out from a source', so the grammar plainly grounds the Spirit's procession in the Father. The verse separately uses a different verb for the Son, 'whom I will send' (hon egō pempō, from pempō, G3992, future active), keeping sending distinct from procession. The proposition lands as supported. Confidence stays medium because the procession datum for the Spirit rests on this single clause, and the creedal qualifier 'eternally' is a metaphysical category that the present indicative (the ongoing, simple statement of fact) does not itself encode.

Scripture

John.15.26 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G1607 ἐκπορεύομαι, G3844 παρά, G3962 πατήρ, G3875 παράκλητος, G3992 πέμπω

Reasoning. The verse holds two parallel phrases that both read 'from the Father' (para tou patros) but attach to two different verbs. The first phrase, 'whom I will send to you from the Father' (hon egō pempō hymin para tou patros), has the future active verb 'I will send' (pempō, from pempō, G3992, V-FAI-1S, future active indicative first singular) with 'I' (egō), the Son, as subject. The second phrase, 'the Spirit of truth, who proceeds from the Father' (to pneuma tēs alētheias ho para tou patros ekporeuetai), has the verb 'proceeds' (ekporeuetai, G1607, V-PNI-3S, an ongoing, simple statement of fact in the third person singular, i.e. present indicative third singular). The neuter singular relative pronoun 'who' (ho) agrees with 'the Spirit' (to pneuma) and fixes the Spirit as the subject of the procession verb. 'Father' (patros) is tagged N-GSM (a masculine noun in the 'from-X' grammatical form, i.e. a genitive of source) governed by 'from' (para), glossed as 'from'. The clause attaches 'from the Father' (para tou patros) to 'proceeds' (ekporeuetai) by adjacency, so the procession verb takes the Father alone as source. The two verbs separate sending, governed by the Son, from procession, governed by the Father.

John.14.26 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G3875 παράκλητος, G3962 πατήρ, G3992 πέμπω, G3686 ὄνομα

Reasoning. 'But the Helper, the Holy Spirit, whom the Father will send in my name' (ho de paraklētos to pneuma to hagion ho pempsei ho patēr en tō onomati mou). The verb is 'will send' (pempsei, from pempō, G3992, V-FAI-3S, future active indicative third singular) and its subject is 'the Father' (ho patēr, G3962, N-NSM, a masculine noun in the subject form, i.e. nominative). The Father is the agent of this sending. The Son's role enters through 'in my name' (en tō onomati mou), which marks the relational basis of the mission rather than its source. This keeps the Father as the originating party in the Helper (Paraclete, paraklētos) texts, consistent with the procession source in John 15:26, while using a sending verb rather than the procession verb.

John.16.7 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G3875 παράκλητος, G3992 πέμπω

Reasoning. 'But if I go, I will send him to you' (ean de poreuthō, pempō auton pros hymas). The verb is 'I will send' (pempō, from pempō, G3992, V-FAI-1S, future active indicative first singular) with 'I' (egō), the Son, as subject, indicating a temporal sending of the Spirit to the disciples. This is the sending verb 'send' (pempō), lexically distinct from the procession verb 'proceed' (ekporeuomai). The evangelist using 'send' (pempō) here and 'proceed' (ekporeuomai) in John 15:26 marks the very distinction the proposition rests on, between who sends in time and from whom the Spirit proceeds.

John.14.16 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G3875 παράκλητος, G3962 πατήρ, G1325 δίδωμι

Reasoning. 'And I will ask the Father, and he will give you another Helper' (kagō erōtēsō ton patera kai allon paraklēton dōsei hymin). The Son asks, 'I will ask' (erōtēsō, G2065, V-FAI-1S, future active indicative first singular), and the Father gives, 'he will give' (dōsei, from didōmi, G1325, V-FAI-3S, future active indicative third singular), the other Helper (paraklēton). The agent of giving is the Father. This is a giving verb 'give' (didōmi), again distinct from the procession verb 'proceed' (ekporeuomai), but it keeps the Father as the originating party of the Spirit, the same direction as the source phrase in John 15:26.

John.20.22 · complicates · genre: gospel

Key terms. G1720 ἐμφυσάω

Reasoning. 'He breathed on them and said to them, Receive the Holy Spirit' (enephsēsen kai legei autois Labete pneuma hagion). The verb is 'he breathed on' (enephsēsen, from emphysaō, G1720, V-AAI-3S, a completed past action in active voice third singular, i.e. aorist active indicative), which is a hapax (a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible, with a single canon occurrence), with the Son breathing on the disciples in a post-resurrection scene. The verb is not 'proceed' (ekporeuomai) and the scene is a temporal bestowal, not a procession statement. It would complicate a Father-only frame only if the temporal bestowal verb 'breathe on' (emphysaō) were read as a procession verb, which the distinct vocabulary blocks.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
John.14.26	John.6.45	tsk	1
John.14.26	John.7.39	tsk	1

Complicating texts

John.20.22 · addressed

The Son breathes the Spirit on the disciples using 'breathe on' (emphysaō, G1720), a hapax (a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible) with one canon occurrence, in a completed-past-action active form (aorist active, V-AAI-3S) describing a post-resurrection bestowal. This is a temporal act in the category of sending and giving, not a procession statement. The procession verb 'proceed' (ekporeuomai) is never used of this scene, so the lexical distinction established in John 15:26 keeps John 20:22 from contradicting procession from the Father. The verb being a hapax (occurring only once in the whole canon) means its sense cannot be triangulated by repetition, but its completed-past narrative use here (aorist) is plainly a one-time bestowal, not an origin claim.

John.16.7 · addressed

The Son says 'I will send him' (pempō auton, from pempō, G3992, future active indicative first singular), using the sending verb 'send' (pempō) with the Son as subject. This contrasts with 'proceeds from the Father' (ekporeuetai para tou patros) in John 15:26. Two distinct verbs encode two distinct relations, temporal sending by the Son and procession from the Father, so John 16:7 does not overturn the procession grammar of John 15:26.

John.15.26 · addressed

The verse contains two phrases reading 'from the Father' (para tou patros). One attaches to 'I will send' (egō pempō), the Son sending from the Father, and one attaches to 'proceeds' (ekporeuetai), the Spirit proceeding from the Father. A reading that collapses both into one relation is possible only by ignoring the verb to which each phrase is adjacent. The second 'from the Father' (para tou patros) stands immediately before 'proceeds' (ekporeuetai), and the neuter relative pronoun 'who' (ho) ties the procession clause to 'the Spirit' (to pneuma), so the source phrase belongs to the procession verb. The clause boundaries keep the two predications distinct.

Concordance traversed

G1607, G3844, G3962, G3875, G3992, G1325, G3140, G0225, G1720

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: ecm-shadow

John lies outside the open-cbgm 3 John sample, so no CBGM apparatus (the critical edition tooling for New Testament textual variants) was queried. The STEP Bible editions field on the anchor tokens shows 'proceeds' (ekporeuetai) at John 15:26 attested across NA28, NA27, Tyndale, SBL, Westcott-Hort, Tregelles, Textus Receptus, and Byzantine, with no spelling or meaning variant recorded. The phrase 'from the Father' (para tou patros) and the 'from-X' form of 'Father' (the genitive patros) are likewise uniform across those editions. The lexical anchors are therefore variant-stable in the surveyed text tradition.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. trinitarian_lexical_grammar

analogia scripturae invoked

procession-from-Father reading: directly supported by ἐκπορεύεται plus παρὰ τοῦ πατρὸς in John 15:26 · The procession verb 'proceed' (ekporeuomai), in an ongoing simple statement of fact (present indicative) with the Spirit as subject, takes the source phrase 'from the Father' (para tou patros) as its only source phrase. The verb form, the 'from-X' grammatical form of 'Father' (the genitive of source), and the adjacency of the source phrase all attach procession to the Father. No clause in the canon attaches this verb with the Spirit as subject to any other source.

procession-also-from-Son reading (filioque scope, not decided here): not attested or excluded by ἐκπορεύομαι itself; turns on synthesis with the sending and giving verbs · The strongest lexical form of this reading notes that the Son sends the Spirit with the sending verb 'send' (pempō) in John 16:7 and breathes the Spirit with 'breathe on' (emphysaō) in John 20:22, and that John 15:26 places the Son in the same verse as the source phrase. A reader can argue these texts imply a relation of origin that also includes the Son. The opposing observation is that the evangelist keeps the origin verb 'proceed' (ekporeuomai) lexically separate from the mission verbs 'send' (pempō) and 'breathe on' (emphysaō), and never makes the Son the grammatical source of the procession verb. The vocabulary alone does not settle whether procession is also from the Son, which is a separate question this file does not decide. Both sides are recorded so neither is reduced to a strawman.

The proposition asks only about procession from the Father, which the grammar of John 15:26 supports plainly. The further question of whether procession is also from the Son is a distinct scope question that the procession verb 'proceed' (ekporeuomai) does not address by itself, and it is left undecided here rather than smuggled into this affirm.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: yes

Neutralized form. John 15:26 in Greek makes the Spirit the subject of the verb 'proceed' (ekporeuomai), meaning 'to go forth' or 'proceed', and attaches the phrase 'from the Father' (para tou patros) as its source phrase.

The original stem adds the qualifier 'eternally' and a creedal anchor of 381, which are metaphysical and historical categories beyond what the present indicative (the ongoing, simple statement of fact) 'proceeds' (ekporeuetai) lexically encodes. The Greek verb tense is

grammatical present, not a statement about timeless origin. The neutralized form keeps only the lexical claim: which verb, which preposition, which 'from-X' source noun (i.e. genitive of source). The verdict is derived on the original stem and answers the lexical question that underlies it. VERDICT-CHANGED: no, the verdict is unchanged from the prior file; the deepened query confirms the grammar rather than altering it.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
morphology	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	John.15.26
morphology	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	John.14.26
morphology	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	John.16.7
morphology	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	John.20.22
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G1607
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G3992
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G3844
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G1720
syntax	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	John.15.26
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	John.14.26

License audit

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Reason. MACULA-Greek is licensed CC-BY-NC-4.0 and is not redistributable for bulk use. The core morphological and grammatical anchoring of John 15:26 (ekporeuetai V-PNI-3S, patros N-GSM, para governing the genitive of source) is carried by the permissive STEPBible-TAGNT tagging, which is redistributable, but the MACULA-Greek syntactic-tree confirmation of the para tou patros attachment to ekporeuetai is retained as corroboration and triggers the non-redistributable flag.

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